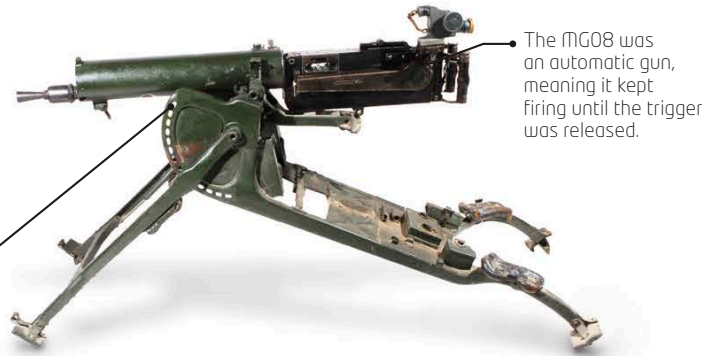


Rapid fire

The Maschinengewehr 08, or MG08, was the German Army's main machine gun. It fired 400 rounds a minute to a distance of 1¼ miles (2 km). The ammunition was fed into the gun on belts, each of which held 250 bullets.

A pin was put through these holes to angle the gun up or down.



The MG08 was an automatic gun, meaning it kept firing until the trigger was released.

Head gear

The *Stahlhelm* "coal scuttle" helmet was used by German troops in World Wars I and II. The side holes were for ventilation. In winter, soldiers stuffed the holes with mud or cloth to keep out cold air.



"Trench fighting is the bloodiest, wildest, most brutal of all There's no mercy there, no going back ..."

—Ernst Jünger, German officer (1895-1998)

Pillboxes

Enemy troops were terrified of attacking pillboxes—the nonstop gunfire from these raised positions was deadly. But pillboxes were also vulnerable to bombs and bullets.

Troops use binoculars to watch their enemies approach.



Soldiers carry spare ammunition in belts.

German long boots are known as marching boots.

Wooden and metal boxes protect ammunition from damage and made sure it stayed dry.

This man's job is to load the machine gun's ammunition quickly and make sure the weapon does not jam.

Handgun

This long-barreled pistol called a Luger was often carried by German artillery officers instead of a rifle.

